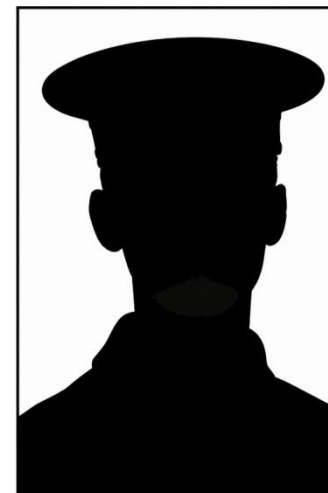
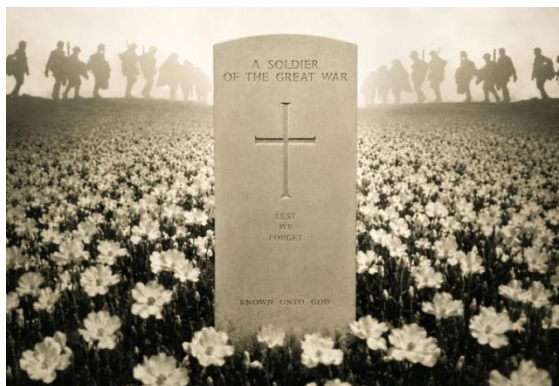




Hedley Hubert Berry

1895 - 1918

Civilian Research

Field Name	Field Data	Source of data
Casualty Name	Hedley Herbert Berry	CWGC 1911 census
Date of Birth	28/5/1895 Sep Qtr 1895, Stow reg district, Suffolk Woolpit, Suffolk	RAF Officer Service Records, Ancestry GRO 1911 census
Date of Death (from Spreadsheet)	27/9/1918 Died of wounds Died in a hospital in Coventry General Hospital Buried Southend on Sea (Sutton) Road Cemetery	CWGC RAF Officer Service Records, Ancestry Find a Grave & newspaper article below CWGC
Age at death (from Spreadsheet)	23 Where does this come from?	Confirmed on headstone which says 24 th year
Marital Status	Not known but I would say single as a wife is	

	not mentioned in any obituaries	
Children (if any)	none	
Occupation prior to Call up		
Parents	John Carter Berry and Lettice Berry	RAF Officer Service Records, Ancestry 1911 census
Listed Address(s)	49 Roxborough Park, Harrow 1 Trinity Avenue, Westcliffe on Sea Lived in Nottingham	1911 census RAF Officer Service Records, Ancestry 1901 census
Parents /Fathers occupation	Engineer	1911 census
Brothers and Sisters	Douglas George Berry (younger) and one more I've yet to find The 1911 census says 3 children but the 1901 census lists 7 (2 or 3 marriages?) - confusing - Fascutt, 21 - Liettice, 20 - Ralph, 18 - Grace, 16 - Ivy, 12 - Hedley, 6 - Douglas, 3	1911 census
Years at John Lyon School		
University (if any)		
Obituary	See newspaper cuttings below	
Additional sources of data		
	Reported to have knowledge of French because he spent a year in Paris	RAF Officer Service Records, Ancestry

War Memorials:	Southend Roll of Honour	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/756111
	Avenue Baptist Church, Westcliff on Sea	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/22625
	John Lyon plaque	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11204
	John Lyon sundial	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11318

Military Research

JLS WWI RoH	BERRY H.H.
CWGC Reference	https://www.cwgc.org/find-war-dead/casualty/357344/berry,-hedley-herbert/
Age	23
DoD	27-Sep-18
Rank	Lt
Regiment	RAF
Location	<u>SOUTHEND-ON-SEA (SUTTON ROAD) CEMETERY</u>
Military details	On September 24, 1918, Lt. Berry was flying an RE8 (serial C2897) biplane belonging to the 1 Aircraft Acceptance Park. While flying over Radford (near Coventry/Warwickshire), his aircraft suffered a mid-air collision with an SE5A fighter pilot aircraft (serial F851).The two aircraft became locked together in mid-air and crashed. His observer/mechanic, 3rd Air Mechanic Percival George Welsman, was killed instantly. Lt. Berry survived the immediate impact but sustained catastrophic injuries and died of his wounds three days later in a local hospital. <u>Before this tragic accident, he was a seasoned pilot who had survived combat flying over the Somme and Messines Ridge with No. 21 Squadron in 1916.</u>

Story of Sacrifice

Hedley Herbert Berry (1895 – 1918)

Hedley Berry was a Royal Air Force pilot who died aged 23 from injuries sustained when his aircraft collided with another aircraft in mid-air over Warwickshire on 24 September 1918, three days before his death in Coventry General Hospital.

Civilian Life

Hedley was born in Woolpit, Suffolk, on 28 May 1895, the son of John Carter Berry and Lettice Berry. The family later lived at 49 Roxborough Park, Harrow, and subsequently at Trinity Avenue, Westcliff-on-Sea. His father was an engineer. Hedley was also reported to have spent a year in Paris, giving him a knowledge of French.

Hedley attended John Lyon School, where his name is commemorated on the school's First World War memorials. Details of his occupation before his military service have not been established in the research Census research is not entirely clear but, according to the 1901 Census, he may have been one of 7 siblings..

Military Life

Hedley served during the WW1 and became a pilot in the Royal Flying Corps. Before his death he had served with No. 21 Squadron, flying over the Somme and Messines Ridge in 1916. The research records him as a Lieutenant because the RFC was part of the Army and used Army ranks. When the Royal Air Force was formed by merging the RFC with the Royal Navy Aviation Service in April 1918, his rank was changed to Flight Lieutenant.

On 24 September 1918, Hedley was flying an RE8 biplane, serial C2897, belonging to the 1 Aircraft Acceptance Park, over Radford in Warwickshire. No. 1 Aircraft Acceptance Park was a vital aviation facility at Radford Aerodrome near Coventry. It served as a primary hub where newly manufactured aircraft from the region's massive industrial base were assembled, flight-tested, and officially accepted into service. The aircraft collided in mid-air with an SE5A fighter, serial F851. The two aircraft became locked together before crashing. Hedley's observer and mechanic, 3rd Air Mechanic Percival George Welsman, was killed immediately. Hedley survived the crash but suffered serious injuries.

Hedley was taken to Coventry General Hospital, where he died from wounds three days later, on 27 September 1918, he was 23.. A subsequent inquest recorded that the two aircraft had collided at a height of approximately 150 feet and that Hedley had suffered four compound fractures. The jury returned a verdict of accidental death. However, the coroner did recommend measures be taken to improve pilots' field of vision.

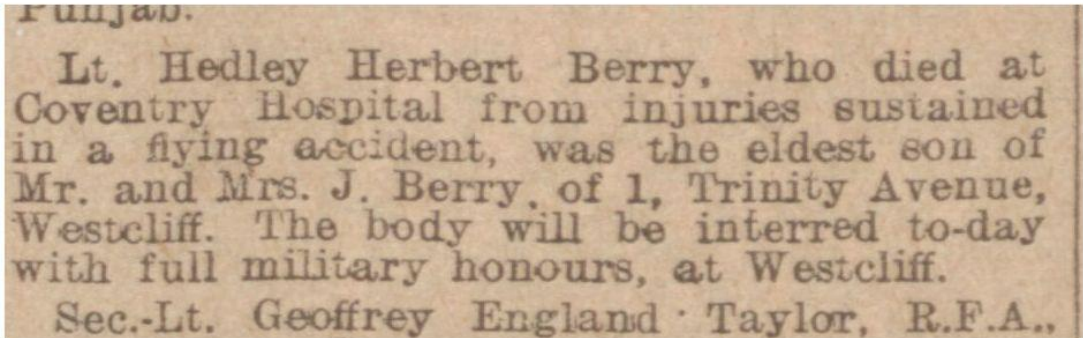
Hedley was buried at Southend-on-Sea (Sutton Road) Cemetery.

Notes & Clippings

From Find a Grave – NB: he doesn't have a CWGC headstone



Leicester Evening Mail 30/9/1918	
Leicester Evening Mail 30/9/1918 ROLL OF HONOUR. BERRY.—Sept. 27th, 1918, General Hospital, Coventry, died of wounds received through collision in the air, after 4 years' service, Flight-Lieut. Hedley Herbert Berry, in his 24th year, beloved son of Mr. and Mrs. J. Berry, 1, Trinity Avenue, Westcliffe-on-Sea, and dearly loved nephew of Mr. and Mrs. F. Krenkow, of Quorn.	Leicester Evening Mail 30/9/1918 ROLL OF HONOUR. BERRY.—Sept. 27th, 1918, General Hospital, Coventry, died of wounds received through collision in the air, after 4 years' service, Flight-Lieut. Hedley Herbert Berry, in his 24th year, beloved son of Mr. and Mrs. J. Berry, 1, Trinity Avenue, Westcliffe-on-Sea, and dearly loved nephew of Mr. and Mrs. F. Krenkow, of Quorn.

Chelmsford Chronicle 4/10/1918 Essex Roll of Honour	
Chelmsford Chronicle 4/10/1918 Essex Roll of Honour 	Chelmsford Chronicle 4/10/1918 Essex Roll of Honour Punjab. Lt. Hedley Herbert Berry, who died at Coventry Hospital from injuries sustained in a flying accident, was the eldest son of Mr. and Mrs. J. Berry, of 1, Trinity Avenue, Westcliff. The body will be interred to-day with full military honours, at Westcliff. Sec.-Lt. Geoffrey England Taylor, R.F.A..

Coventry Standard, 27/9/1918 – this explains why he ended up in Coventry General Hospital

Coventry Standard, 27/9/1918 – this explains why he ended up in Coventry General Hospital



AVIATION ACCIDENT.

An air-mechanic was killed and two officers badly injured through an aviation accident in Warwickshire on Tuesday morning. Two machines—a single seater and a two-seater—came into collision and crashed to earth locked together. The three occupants were taken to hospital. Second Air-Mechanic Welsman (Wimborne) was found to be dead. Lieutenants Charles Geoffrey Baker (London) and Hedley Hubert Berry (Westgate-on-Sea) were seriously injured. An inquest is fixed for Friday.

4/10/1918 The Coventry Standard

4/10/1918 The Coventry Standard

THE COVENTRY STANDARD.

FLYING FATALITIES,

TWO MEN KILLED IN THE MIDLANDS.

An inquest was held on Friday concerning the death of Second-Air-Mechanic George Percival Welsman, aged 31, whose home was at Wimborne, and also Lieutenant Hedley Hubert Berry, aged 23, who resided at Westgate-on-Sea.

On Tuesday morning both men, who belonged to the R.A.F., were flying in Warwickshire, when at a distance of 150 feet or upwards the machines collided, locked together, and came down turning round and round, and getting into what was known as the spin. Second-Air-Mechanic Welsman received such terrible injuries that he died instantaneously, and Lieut. Berry, who received four compound fractures of the limbs, recovered for a time, but lapsed into unconsciousness and passed away on Friday morning.

The jury returned verdicts of accidental death in both cases, and on the suggestion of the Coroner recommended the military authorities to consider whether some means could not be devised which would enable pilots to get a better field of vision.

It was also stated that a noise on the ground diverted the attention of the pilot of one of the machines at the time the accident occurred. Both pilots were expert flyers.

4/10/1918 The Coventry Standard

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